

Stalingrad, hell on earth.

The Germans launch a major summer offensive in 1942. To keep their tanks fueled up and rolling, they must control the oil wells in the Caucasus. To make Russian armor grind to a halt, they must cut the supply lines along the Volga river.

A very simple plan in theory but miles away from a reality with infinite numbers of enemies, backed with inexhaustible supplies, in a most pitiless climate…

6. Armee has been ordered to seize the industrial city of Stalingrad. 24. Panzer-Division is part of XXIV Panzer-Korps which has been detached from 4. Panzer-Armee as reinforcement.

After two months of brutal combat, little remains of the heroic zeal that imbued the Germans at the start of the Case Blue Offensive (Fall Blau).
They are exhausted, muddy… in a deplorable state.
The dire lack of infantry units is painfully clear as armored and motorized divisions are sent to fight in urban terrain, an arena that is already quite challenging for that branch of service. Moreover, manifold fuel shortages make matters even worse.

With their numbers down to 50%, 24 PzD is not spared, despite having been engaged less than other units. The Russians have been pushed back, slowly but steadily.

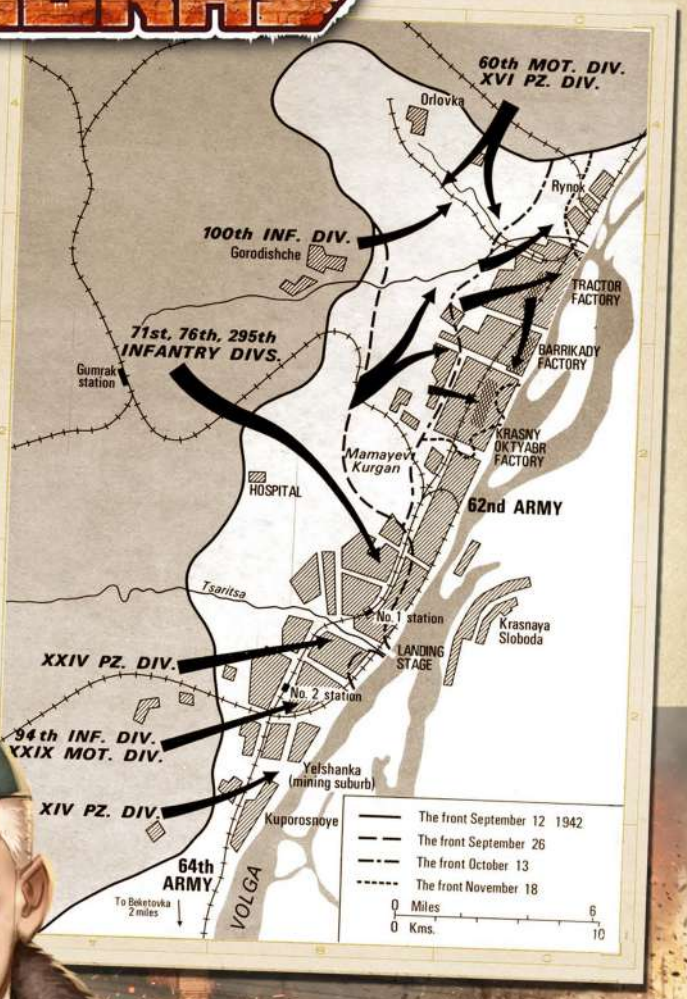
Just a little effort and the Germans control the city.

It's a mere matter of a few more days.

Victory is within their grasp!

The Führer said so...

The historical outcome is quite different...



QUITE A RECEPTION...

Eastern Front
September 1942



Stalingrad, 15th September 1942

24. Panzer-Division hasn't been engaged yet even though the 6th Army started the offensive the day before.

Gruppe Edelsheim is finally ordered to launch a surprise attack at 0330 h.

They must reach the southern station, thereby piercing enemy lines and destroying defenses in depth to prevent the Russians from falling back as they have done so far.

They are up against frontoviki... who stick to their ground like ticks to a dog...

RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

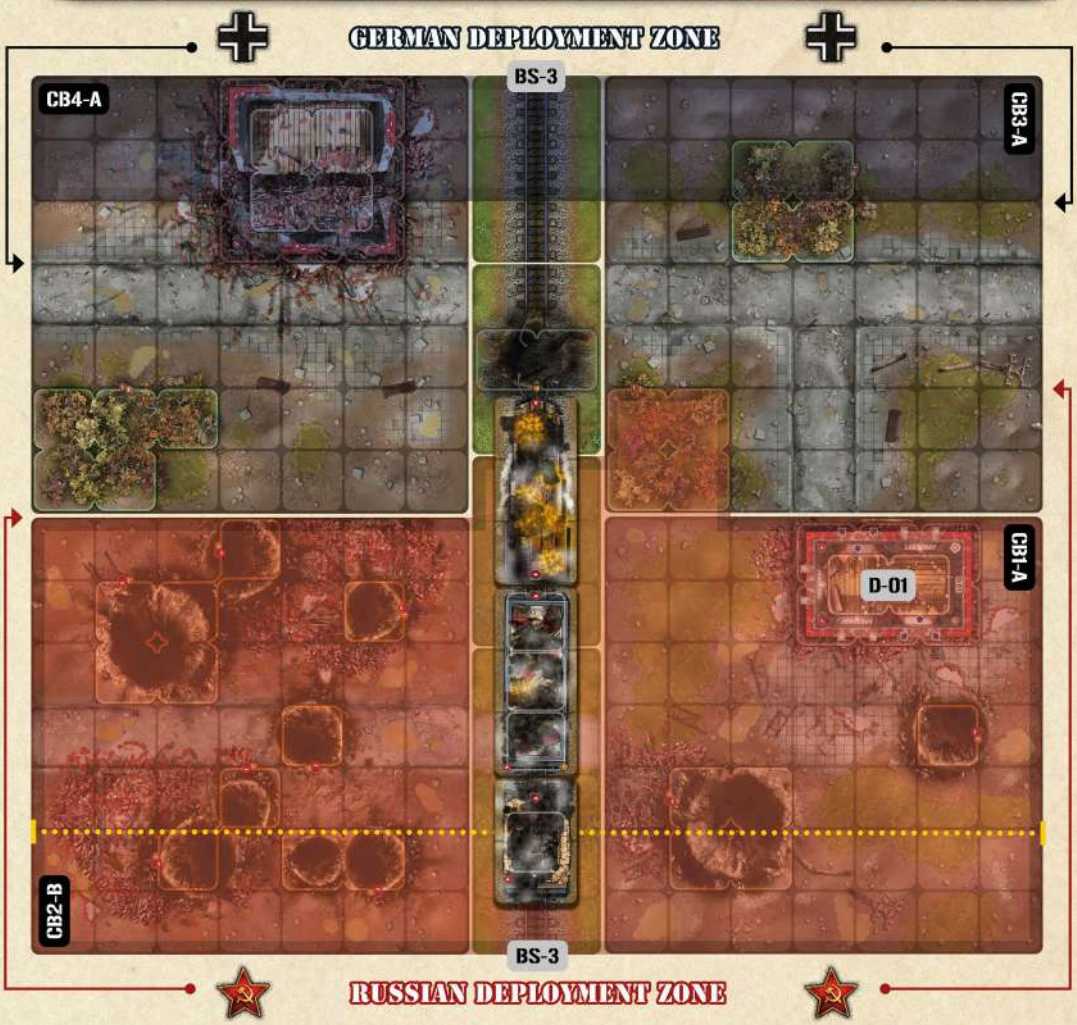
ELEMENTS OF THE 62ND ARMY



ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE EDELSHEIM 4, 24. PANZER-DIVISION



BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION



The **Germans** have the **Initiative**.

The **Soviets** deploy first.

The **Germans** deploy next.

Turn 3: The **AT Rifle Group** and **Danilov** enter through the eastern or western side, during the Activation Phase or the Supply Phase.

Each player draws **4 Action Cards**.

The game lasts for **7 Turns**.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

MOVE AT LEAST 1 VEHICLE AND 2 INFANTRY UNITS ACROSS THE YELLOW LINE

KEEP THE GERMANS FROM MOVING AT LEAST 1 VEHICLE AND 2 INFANTRY UNITS ACROSS THE YELLOW LINE

EPILOGUE

Gruppe Edelsheim launches the attack at 0330 h whilst Gruppe Hellermann secures the flanks. They encounter strongpoints whose occupants stand their ground with grim determination. It will take intense close combat and a good deal of grenades to flush out the defenders.

The Germans even have Panzer support but to no avail. The attackers are lacking assault forces in reserve. Their advance is stopped.

On this difficult terrain, combat is chaotic and terrible. The Russians literally fight tooth and nail using anything they can grab : bricks, rusty iron rods, knives, forks... anything...

Rather than to give up an inch of ground, frontoviki are crushed by armored vehicles whilst their comrades fight on to the last man.

At 1135 h, the defending forces are finally overwhelmed.

Scenario Requirements

Core Box: Heroes of Stalingrad
Expansion: Heroes of Stalingrad Battle Pack
Terrain Pack: Battleground Set #3 (Rails & Roads)

Scenario created and written by:
Thia, Yann and Laurent Duclos.

NEXT STATION... HELL

Eastern Front
September 1942



Stalingrad, 15th September 1942

At 1210 h, the path of Gruppe Edelsheim is blocked again. Stukas are called in for some desperately needed air support. The notorious dive-bombers thoroughly batter the Russian positions. Unsurprisingly, several German troops also suffer from the bombing as friend and foe are mingled in melee.

The Germans vigilantly advance again at 1600 h along the railroad tracks, past the warehouses and station buildings, only to encounter more Russians, hell-bent on punishing the invader.

Ultimately, 24. Panzer-Division succeeds in piercing Russian defensive lines before advancing deeply into enemy territory. Finding themselves on the verge of being surrounded, the Soviets fall back towards the Volga river.

This matter is far from over. The frontoviki shall exact a toll from the Germans for entering this city and the price will be painfully high...

RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF THE 62ND ARMY



ELEMENTS OF KAMPFGRUPPE EDELSHEIM 4, 24. PANZER-DIVISION



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BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION



The **Germans** have the **Initiative**.

Koulikov is deployed inside the station.

Troops of both factions enter the game in the Activation or the Supply Phase, at a rate of one Recruitment Tile per Turn. Orders provided by a Recruitment Tile's core troops or a group are not available until the start of the Turn in which these units enter the game.

Players choose the order of appearance.

Turn 1 & 2: **Germans** advance through the western side.

David Kintz turns up with either German Recruitment Tile.

Turn 1, 2 & 3: **Russians** move in through the northern side.

Danilov arrives with any of the Russian Recruitment Tiles.

Each player draws 4 **Action Cards**.

The game lasts for **10 Turns**. Place the **END marker** next to the second square on the Turn Chart.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

CONTROL OF THE OBJECTIVE

CONTROL OF THE OBJECTIVE

EPILOGUE

The dreary gray mass of the colossal grain silo dominates the scene to the East. The Panzergrenadiers are not in the mood for sightseeing as they restlessly protect the flanks of their tanks. Any progress is hindered by the difficult terrain. Moreover, many mines lie hidden, armed and ready to cause death and destruction. The Germans are in control of the station at 1830 h. They are given new orders. The Grenadiers stay behind to secure the station and set up Division HQ whilst the Panzers advance toward Tsaritsa Gorge. This action is a success for 24. Panzer-Division. Be that as it may, the fight for the city has only just begun. Many harder and bloodier battles lie ahead.

Stalingrad shall never be given up by its defenders who are explicitly forbidden to retreat. They are to hold their ground and fight viciously, with excruciating patience, as other forces are secretly mustered and readied for a decisive blow. Despite staggering losses but with their seemingly unlimited resources, the Russians can simultaneously maintain the defense of the city, yet still gather humongous masses of troops and material for a counterattack.

Mother Russia will provide. In a war of attrition the invader will lose...

THE FINAL ASSAULT

Eastern Front
November 1942



Stalingrad, 11th November 1942

The Germans have captured most of the city and now, with the Volga river in sight, the 6th Army launches Operation Hubertus to mop up the remaining Russian resistance in Stalingrad. Several pioneer battalions have been deployed to destroy Soviet strongpoints in the factory buildings once and for all.

79. Infantrie-Division will assault the Red October factory, particularly Hall 4, also known as the *Martenovskii* shop, where enemy resistance has been maintained since October.

Pionier-Bataillon 179 is being reinforced by the veterans from 3. Panzerpionier-Bataillon 40 commanded by Oberleutnant Rost.

Totaling about 120 men, the pioneers are organized into four assault groups (Keil 1-4). Support will be provided by 1/208 IR.

The attack is to start at 0355 h, it is nighttime, it is cold… and the Russians are waiting…

RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF 3/120TH REGIMENT, 39TH GUARDS RIFLE DIVISION AND 2/253RD REGIMENT, 45TH DIVISION









ELEMENTS OF PANZER-PIONIER-BATAILLON 40, PIONIER-BATAILLON 179 AND 1/208TH IR (KEIL 1)

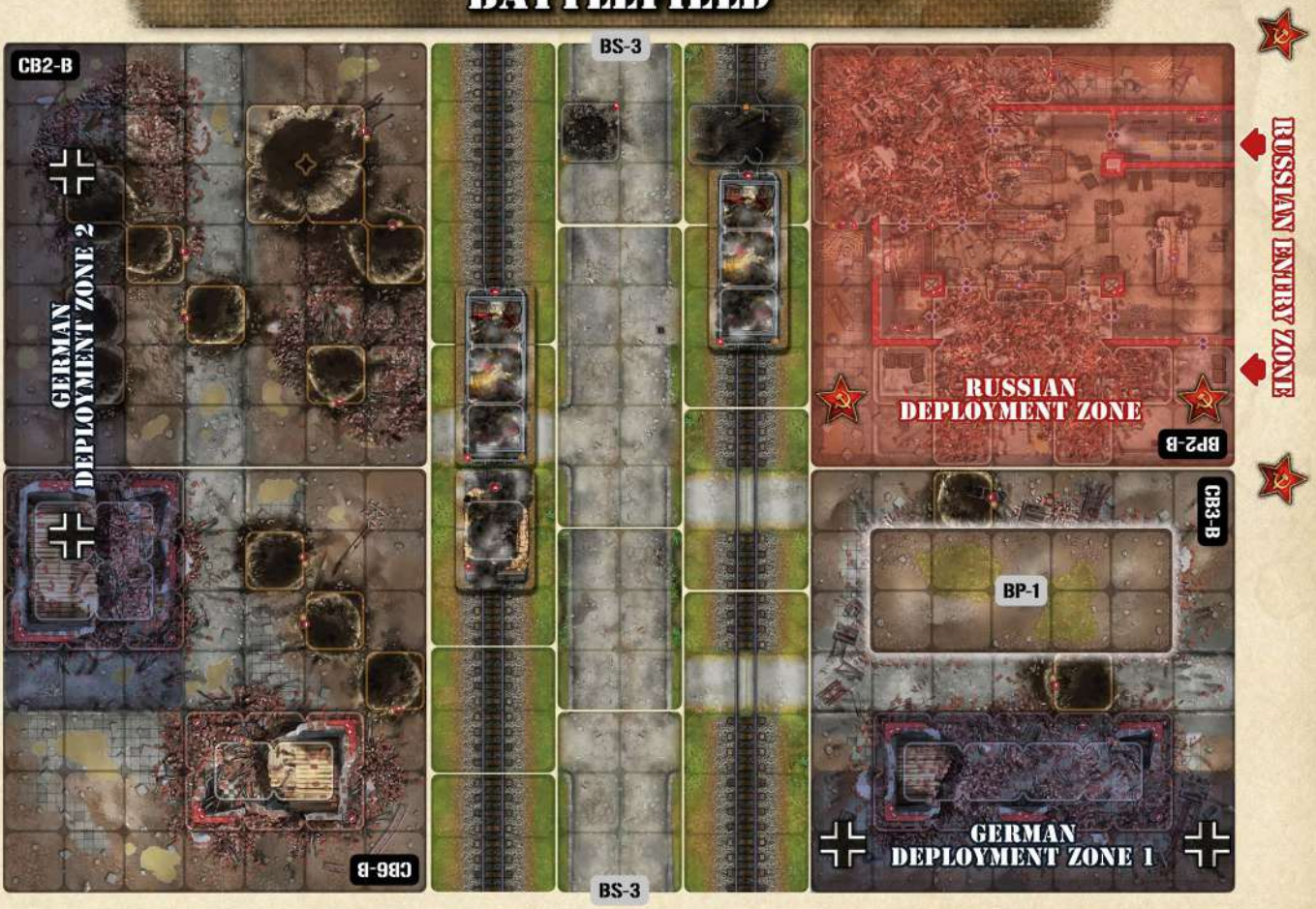








BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION



The **Germans** have the **Initiative**.

The **Russians**, except the **Siberian Rifle Battalion**, deploy first.

The **Germans** are deployed next.

First group, **Panzergrenadiere** deploy in **German Deployment Zone 1**.

Second group, **Die Geisterabteilung** and **Aufklärungsabteilung 40** deploy in **German Deployment Zone 2**.

Feldkommando deploys with either group.

During Turn 1: The **Russian Artillery Recruitment Option** must be spent. Place and resolve the template three times in succession. Dispersion is 3 interspaces.

Siberian Rifle Battalion units enter the game through the eastern side of tile **BP2-B** during the Activation Phase or the Supply Phase.

Orders provided by the core troops or a group are not available until the start of the Turn in which these units enter the game.

Turn 3: The core troops of the **Siberian Rifle Battalion** Recruitment Tile appear first.

Turns 4, 5 & 6: AT Rifle Group, **Flamer Group** and **Support Group**, join the fight at a rate of one group per Turn.

The Russian player chooses the order of appearance.

Each player draws **4 Action Cards**.

The game lasts for **10 Turns**. Place the **END marker** next to the second square on the Turn Chart.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

At the end of the scenario the player with the most units inside the destroyed factory on tile **BP2-B** wins the game.

EPILOGUE

At 0340 h, artillery starts to rumble. Shells fall down on and behind the German lines. Unteroffizier Sepp Lanz of Pionier-Bataillon 179 describes: *"Explosions all around. The building trembles. This cannot be our artillery! Peering through the windows we can see flashes of guns across the Volga river. Did the Russians get wind of our plans?"*

The Soviets simply suspected something might be brewing. Since they have no lack of shells, their artillery isn't frugal. An occasional but thorough barrage now and then just might ruin enemy intentions.

Kiels 2 and 3 lose 5 men each already. Nevertheless, the attack is launched as planned. German heavy artillery hammers hall 4 to deaden any Russians still there and prevent reinforcements from reaching the strongpoints.

Whilst bypassing hall 3, Rost's men learn that the machine gun nests are still intact. Of all the Assault groups, theirs has to cover the biggest distance to reach hall 4.

Soon they are spotted and forced to sprint from one covered position to the next before finding refuge in a huge bomb crater. It would mean total massacre if they tried to vacate that spot. They are pinned.

During the first minutes of the intrusion, the other Kiels make slightly more headway but the defenders give them a run for their money once the surprise effect is gone. Despite suffering 45% casualties, the Russians do not give in and succeed in repelling the assault.

Do not poke a hornet nest...

Scenario Requirements

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